

NOVARTIS PHARMACEUTICALS - MEDICAL RELEASES & INTERACTIONS LOG

PRODUCT PROFILE: METFORMIN HYDROCHLORIDE (GENERIC CLASS)

INDICATIONS:

Metformin is an oral antihyperglycemic agent indicated as an adjunct to diet and exercise to improve glycemic control in adults with type 2 diabetes mellitus.

DRUG-DRUG INTERACTIONS AND COMPLIANCE WARNINGS:

1. Iodinated Contrast Media: Metformin therapy must be temporarily discontinued at the time of or prior to an iodinated contrast imaging procedure, and withheld for 48 hours after the procedure. It should only be reinstituted after renal function has been re-evaluated and found to be normal. Failure to do so significantly increases the risk of lactic acidosis.
2. Alcohol Co-ingestion: Acute or chronic alcohol intake can potentiate the effect of Metformin on lactate metabolism, drastically elevating the probability of acute metabolic crisis. Patients are strictly advised against heavy alcohol use while on this therapeutic schedule.
3. Cimetidine: Concomitant administration of cationic drugs such as cimetidine can increase peak metformin plasma concentrations by up to 60%, requiring careful dosage titration.